

Joshing — Exploratory QA Report

Text edition. The full edition with embedded screenshots was saved to your Downloads folder from Chrome.

Full walkthrough of onboarding & auth, gameplay, friends, knowledge/profile and invites, judged against Joshing's product principles.

Build: joshing-11.vercel.app · v1.0.0 **Date:** Friday, September 25, 2026

Accounts: A = Duo Prova (555-222-2222) · B = Trio Third (555-333-3333) **Viewport:** Chrome desktop, ~990×650

4 CRITICAL	20 SHOULD-FIX	18 NICE-TO-HAVE	0 CONSOLE ERRORS SEEN
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Overall summary

Joshing's core loop is in good shape and its voice mostly delivers on the philosophy. Near-misses and typos (“Lorenzo de Medici”, “Pittsburg”, “catch 22”, “charles the 8th”) are accepted. Wrong answers read as shared discovery (“Now it's in yours too”, “Between us!”), and the weekly ceremony turns misses into “Things you didn't have a week ago.” There are no streaks or leaderboards anywhere in the UI.

The serious problems are in the **social graph**. Blocking hides people but doesn't end the friendship: while the block was active, the invite flow said the two users were “already friends,” and unblocking quietly put the friendship back. A blocked user could also redeem the blocker's invite link. Grading has one clear hole in the **fail-toward-the-player** principle: a partly correct answer (one of two deformities) is marked wrong, even though the feedback itself says “Right deformity.”

The rest is mostly **state consistency and legibility**. The progress dots count bonus answers as base answers and use color alone to show right or wrong. Recap and next-round times contradict each other. Catch-up labels today's question “From yesterday” and gives 0.25× points. The SMS opt-in reappears at every login. A few places lean on points more than a non-competitive game should.

Test limitations. Signing up with a new number wasn't possible: non-test numbers return “Unable to send code” (SMS provider), so a fresh signup and co-invitee auto-friending couldn't be completed end-to-end. Profile setup was reviewed through the in-app *Developer tools* → *Setup & areas* replay. There is no resend-code control, so resend and expired-code paths couldn't be exercised. Account

B (555-333-3333) already existed as “Trio Third” and was blocked by A at the start of testing, which surfaced the blocking bugs below.

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1. Onboarding & auth

What worked

- ✓ Phone input formats as you type; letters in the OTP field are stripped (numeric-only), and `autocomplete="one-time-code"` is set.
- ✓ Invite-only gating is clear: an unknown number gets “Joshing is invite-only. Ask a friend who's already on Joshing to send you an invite.”
- ✓ Wrong OTP → “Code invalid or expired.” Correct OTP (000000) signs in straight away.
- ✓ The SMS reminder opt-in after login has clear TCPA-style consent copy (“up to one message per day... Consent is not a condition of purchase”) and a real “Not right now.”
- ✓ Profile setup checks the username live (“@qab is available.”), auto-suggests a handle from the name, and makes you pick at least 3 interest topics, with Undo on removals.

Screenshot 02-invite-only-error — Invite-only error
below the fold

(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Invite-only error. The message only shows after scrolling, so at the default viewport Continue looks like it did nothing.

Screenshot 04-otp-invalid — OTP invalid state
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Wrong OTP. The “Code invalid or expired” banner also sits below the fold. There is no resend-code link, and the “or” divider leads to only one option.

Screenshot 05-sms-optin — SMS opt-in
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

SMS opt-in after login. Good consent copy, but it comes back at every login (see issue S4).

Screenshot 41-setup-profile — Profile setup
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Profile setup (dev replay). Name and @username are required; there's no avatar step. A 1-character name just greys out Continue with no message.

Screenshot 42-setup-interests — Setup interests
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Areas of knowledge. The inviter (“Maya”) pre-picks topics; 3–12 are required, and “Start with these” stays disabled below 3.

Screenshot 43-setup-add-own-disappears — Sticky footer overlaps input
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

All suggestions removed. The sticky footer covers the “Add your own” input until you scroll, which reads as a dead end (“Pick at least 3 to start”).

Issues found

- **SHOULD-FIX** Auth errors (“Use a US phone number,” invite-only, invalid code, “Unable to send code”) render below the fold with no `aria-live/role="alert"`. The empty or short phone case shows nothing in view.
- **SHOULD-FIX** There's no “Resend code” or countdown on the OTP screen. A user whose SMS never arrives can only go back through “Change number.”
- **SHOULD-FIX** The SMS reminder takeover reappears on every login for both accounts, even after “Not right now.”
- **NICE** The OTP placeholder literally shows “000000” (the test code), and the input has no label or `maxLength`. The login card repeats the legal copy twice (“Terms and Privacy” and “By signing in you agree to our Terms & Conditions”).
- **NICE** Setup: there's no avatar option. Validation disables Continue without saying why, and the sticky footer overlaps the “Add your own” field.

2. Gameplay

What worked

- ✓ **Grading fails toward the player on ambiguity and typos:** “Lorenzo de Medici” for Lorenzo *di Pierfrancesco* de' Medici → “It stuck.” “Pittsburg” → Locked in. “catch 22” → Locked in. “charles the 8th” → Charles VIII ✓. “a fellow of infinite jest” ✓.
- ✓ **Wrong answers read as connection moments:** “× You'll know this one next time. / Now it's in yours too,” a one-line empathetic diagnosis (“Right opera, wrong character—Papageno's got the fun bird-catcher vibes”), a “Between us!” aside, and an “Argue your point” appeal.
- ✓ “Not for me” has three good, non-punitive options: Skip for now, Never show this question, and Rest this topic.
- ✓ New-territory prompts (“Add Catch-22 to your topics? Yes, sometimes / Yes, often / Not now”) work and show up immediately in the Knowledge → Frequency view.
- ✓ The weekly ceremony reframes misses as “Things you didn't have a week ago” and ends with “See you next Sunday” — no streak pressure.
- ✓ No console errors or exceptions during any gameplay flow.

Question flow & grading

Screenshot 06-daily-second-look — Second look item
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Missed-question return (“Second look · Last seen June 22”). Opens the Daily Five. Header dots show 2 base + 2 bonus slots.

Screenshot 07-ambiguous-correct — Ambiguous answer marked correct
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Ambiguous answer accepted. “Lorenzo de Medici” is credited, and the explanation clarifies which Lorenzo.

Screenshot 10-wrong-answer-card — Wrong answer card
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Clearly wrong answer (Papageno). Warm framing. The red ✕ also has text, so it doesn't rely on color alone.

Screenshot 16-partial-marked-wrong — Partial answer marked wrong
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

CRITICAL **Partly correct answer marked wrong.** “hunchback” for “a hunched back and a withered arm.” The grader admits “Right deformity... you caught half the picture” and still gives ✕.

Screenshot 31-catchup-half-right-wrong — Half right wrong again in catch-up
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Same thing in Catch-up. “withered arm” → “Half right” → ✕ “Not this time,” +0 points.

Screenshot 13-lenient-correct-new-territory — Lenient correct and new territory
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

“catch 22” accepted. Followed by the New-territory offer.

Screenshot 55-show-answer-red-dot — Show me the answer
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

“Show me the answer.” It shows up as the player's own chat bubble (“show me the answer”) and turns the dot red, the same as a wrong answer.

Screenshot 56-not-for-me-sheet — Not for me sheet
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

“Not for me” options. Clear, but they point to “Settings > Hidden questions” and “Manage your topics,” and neither label exists in the app.

Bonus questions & progress indicator

The bonus score looks additive: the home header keeps base (5) and bonus (+2) separate. But the in-round progress indicator mixes them up, and it was reproduced on both accounts.

Screenshot 09-bonus2-and-red-dot — Bonus answer fills base dot
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

SHOULD-FIX Bonus 1 (wrong) filled the 2nd base dot red while both bonus dots stayed empty. The topic chip “Catch-22” also gives away the answer to the question below it.

Screenshot 15-dots-full-before-q5 — All dots full before Q5
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Every dot is filled while question 5 is still unanswered. Bonuses were also served *before* base questions 4 and 5.

Screenshot 58-bonus-fills-base-dot-repro — Repro on account B
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Reproduced on account B. A bonus answer filled base dot 5 green; bonus dots stayed hollow.

Screenshot 27-home — Home card
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Home “Today’s five.” Right and wrong are shown by green and red dots only. The accessible label says “2 of 5 answered” while all 5 dots are filled. “Five new tomorrow at 1 PM” contradicts the summary’s “Saturday’s five arrive at noon.”

Reactions, appeals & the “connection” loop

- **SHOULD-FIX** I found no way to react on a wrong answer during play. The only social actions are Like and Share on summary cards, and the round never invites you to react or reach out when you miss.
- **SHOULD-FIX** “Argue your point” submits silently: the button disappears with no confirmation, no status, and no way to see the outcome. The character counter shows *remaining* characters as “241 / 300,” which reads as “used.”

Screenshot 11-argue-your-point — Argue your point sheet
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Argue-your-point sheet. Its Submit button is hidden behind the fixed answer bar until you scroll.

Screenshot 12-argue-counter — Counter
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Counter reads “241 / 300” after typing 59 characters.

Missed-question returns (Catch-up)

Screenshot 29-catchup-from-yesterday — From yesterday label wrong
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

SHOULD-FIX A question answered minutes earlier comes back as “From yesterday.” It’s served straight away, while the answer is still fresh.

Screenshot 30-catchup-quarter-points — Quarter points
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

PRINCIPLE “+3 points · Catch-up · 0.25× points.” Discounting catch-up answers punishes missing a day, which is a streak mechanic under another name.

End of round, recap, ceremony & “Lately”

Screenshot 17-finished-card — Finished card
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

“Today’s Joshing: finished. Solid.” Calm and non-coercive.

Screenshot 18-ceremony-1 — Ceremony
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

“See my recap” opens last week’s ceremony (Week 13 · Sep 13–20, which is 8 days labeled “Seven days”), not today’s recap.

Screenshot 19-ceremony-mastered — What you mastered
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

“What you mastered.” The items listed only moved Establishing → Familiar, so “mastered” overclaims.

Screenshot 21-ceremony-overflow — Ceremony overflow
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

SHOULD-FIX Slide 4 overflows. Question text runs underneath “Tap to continue.”

Screenshot 23-share-card-points — Share card
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

PRINCIPLE The share card’s headline is “200 points this cycle.” The ceremony itself celebrates 15 correct answers; points aren’t shown during play and are a comparative, scoreboard-style metric.

Screenshot 25-summary-territory-overlay — Summary overlay
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Daily summary. The floating “Saturday’s five arrive at noon” panel covers “Refine your game” and the question cards.

Screenshot 26-summary-questions — Summary questions
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Today's questions. Every card says “by Maid Acasa,” an account that isn't a friend of either tester (see privacy).

Screenshot 28-lately — Lately
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

“Lately” feed. It only holds the weekly-reflection notice; B's empty state is friendly. There was no daily reflection.

3. Friend system

What worked

- ✓ Search by exact @handle (case-insensitive) or phone in any format works. A non-match offers a personal invite or an invite link.
- ✓ Search is rate-limited: after about 12 rapid searches you get “Please wait 17 seconds before searching again.”
- ✓ Blocking hides both people from each other's search, in both directions, and the block persists across sessions.
- ✓ The incoming request card is gentle and protects the decliner (“Declining won't notify them”). Unfriend has an inline “Keep” escape hatch.
- ✓ After a decline, a second request from the sender is suppressed: it never reached B.
- ✓ Friend profiles show “Common ground / Proven together” overlap, the friend's portrait, and their questions to answer.

Screenshot 44-friends-page — Friends page
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Friends (A). “Questions created 28 (you answered 0)” for Uno, even though A had just answered two bonus questions “from Uno's world.”

Screenshot 46-search-rate-limit — Rate limit
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Rate limit works. The countdown doesn't tick, though (still “17 seconds” well afterwards), and it stays up after switching tabs.

Blocking

Screenshot 62-A-blocked-trio-third — A blocked Trio
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Starting state. A had already blocked Trio Third (B). The page says “Unblocking doesn't restore any connection you had before.”

Screenshot 50-already-friends-contradiction — Already friends
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

CRITICAL With the block active, A's personal-
invite flow for B's number said “You're already
friends with Terry Tester.” A's friend list and search
both said otherwise.

Screenshot 63-unblock-restores-friendship — Unblock restores friendship
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

CRITICAL After Unblock, B showed up straight away as “Friends ✓” and back in A’s list. The block never removed the friendship, which contradicts both the block confirmation and the unblock copy.

Screenshot 72-block-confirm-copy — Block confirm
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Block confirmation says it “removes any existing connection between you.” Afterwards you land on Friends with no confirmation message.

Requests, decline & re-request

Screenshot 64-friend-request-modal — Request modal
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Request modal promises the note is shown: “they’ll see it with the request.”

Screenshot 67-B-incoming-request-no-note — Incoming request without note
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

SHOULD-FIX B’s incoming request has no note (“QA test request” is missing). “0m ago” should read “just now.”

Screenshot 68-declined-badge-stale — Stale badge
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

After Decline, the Friends tab still shows a red “1” badge. The empty-state copy “You haven’t invited anyone yet” mixes up friends and invites.

Screenshot 70-resend-after-decline-silent — Resend silent
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

SHOULD-FIX Re-sending after a decline fails silently. The modal closes and the button goes back to “Add friend.” Suppression works, but the sender gets confusing feedback and can work out that they were declined.

Suggestions, profiles & privacy

Screenshot 53-common-ground-color-only — Common ground
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

SHOULD-FIX **Common-ground bubbles use color alone** (navy = you, orange = Uno). There are no values or patterns, so it doesn't work for color-blind users or in grayscale print.

Screenshot 71-stranger-profile-mutuals — Stranger profile
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Mutual friends only appear on a non-friend's profile (“No mutual friends yet”). The Friends page has no suggestions list. The stranger's knowledge portrait is public by default.

Screenshot 39-privacy-discovery — Privacy toggles
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

PRIVACY **“Let people I've never met discover me” is ON**, while “Suggest me through mutual friends” and contact matching are OFF. Please confirm stranger discovery defaults to off. The + button covers the “Findable” toggle.

Screenshot 52-friend-profile-uno — Friend profile
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Friend profile. Clear. But the friend's portrait card is headed “YOUR KNOWLEDGE PORTRAIT,” and point totals (1,070 vs your 976) invite comparison.

- **PRIVACY** Every question in both accounts' rounds says “by Maid Acasa,” an account that is friends with neither tester, next to “from Uno's world.” If Maid Acasa is a real player, a stranger's name is reaching feeds without consent. If it's a house or AI author persona, label it that way. The two labels also contradict each other about who wrote the question.
- **NICE** Search results can't be clicked, so there's no path to view or block a non-friend from search. Searching your own number says “No matching player found” instead of “That's you.”

4. Knowledge / profile system

What worked

- ✓ The knowledge portrait gives a readable one-line identity (“A mind that is building around...”) with bubble sizes and text levels (Familiar/Establishing), so level isn't shown by color alone.
- ✓ Declaring an interest works: “Yes, often” for Catch-22 immediately put it under *Often* in the Frequency view, and friends' bonus questions came from that territory.
- ✓ The per-territory sheet lets you pick Often, Sometimes, Blue Moon, Never or Remove, all in plain language.
- ✓ Privacy controls per section (Knowledge base, Questions, Friends list) with “View as friend / public” previews are excellent.

Screenshot 32-knowledge-portrait — Portrait
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Portrait. The card header says “Joshing” instead of the player's name. “+3 more territories” (8 total) doesn't match “across 15 territories.”

Screenshot 34-domain-view-catch22-domain — Domain view
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

SHOULD-FIX **Taxonomy.** The user-added “Catch-22” became a top-level *domain* alongside Literature. Elsewhere, Australian Geography is filed under History, and Mozart and US State Capitals under “Other interests.”

Screenshot 35-mastery-view-grey-legend — Mastery legend
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Mastery view. All four legend swatches (Mastery/Solid/Familiar/Establishing) are the same grey, so the legend explains nothing. Numbers inside circles are very low contrast.

Screenshot 36-frequency-view — Frequency view
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Frequency view reflects the declared interest immediately.

Screenshot 37-territory-frequency-modal — Territory modal
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Territory sheet. Clear options. Escape doesn't close it, and the swatch color (red) doesn't match the territory's bubble (blue-grey).

Screenshot 40-dev-tools-exposed — Dev tools
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

SHOULD-FIX

Developer tools on the production profile (Reset today's Daily Five, Trigger noon reset, Points diagnostic). Make sure these are role-gated and not visible to real players.

- **NICE** The “Add a territory” suggestions include “Golden Era Broadway Musicals,” which is already on the map.
- **NICE** The legend note “Numbers inside circles = questions you've written that others have answered” is hard to parse and the digits are nearly invisible.

5. Invite system

What worked

- ✓ Up to three tagged invite links, each with categories, a “friends joined” count, and Share, Edit and Delete controls.
- ✓ The personal invite (“Who came to mind? / A few ideas, lightly held”) is warm, gives the recipient an easy out, and asks you to text it yourself.
- ✓ The invite landing personalizes the login (“Duo invited you to Joshing…”).
- ✓ An invalid token lands on a graceful “This invitation link is no longer valid” page with a way forward.

Screenshot 47-invitations-links — Invite links
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Invite links. Each category chip has a colored dot (green or blue) with no legend or text explaining what the color means.

Screenshot 48-people-invited-terry — People invited
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

“People you invited” shows B as *Accepted Sep 14* and “now you can trade questions more easily,” yet B wasn’t in A’s friend list.

Screenshot 54-invite-landing — Invite landing
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Invite landing. The link’s topic chips aren’t shown here, even though Dev tools describes a “topic-chip card on the login screen.”

Screenshot 59-B-no-friends-after-redeem — B no friends
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

CRITICAL **B (blocked by A) redeemed A’s link and signed in.** There was no acknowledgement and no friendship, and B couldn’t find A. Yet B’s next round served bonus questions “from Duo + others’ worlds.”

Screenshot 73-invalid-invite-link — Invalid link
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Invalid or expired link is handled gracefully.

Screenshot 49-personal-invite — Personal invite
(image embedded in the browser-built version of this report)

Personal invite, step 1. It accepts a number that already belongs to an existing (and blocked) player, and only reports “already friends” after the ideas step.

- **SHOULD-FIX** Redeeming a link as an existing user gives no confirmation (“You're now connected with Duo”) and drops straight into the SMS prompt, so the invite context is lost.
- **UNTESTED** Fresh-number redemption and co-invitee auto-friending: blocked by “Unable to send code” for non-test numbers. Recommend a seeded test number to cover these paths.

6. Prioritized issue list

CRITICAL

ID	ISSUE	REPRO / EVIDENCE
C1	Blocking doesn't remove the friendship, and unblocking silently restores it (contradicts “removes any existing connection” and “Unblocking doesn't restore any connection”).	A blocks B → A: Invite a friend → B's number → “You're already friends.” A: Blocked people → Unblock B → search B → “Friends ✓”; B is back in A's list. (Screens 50, 63)
C2	A blocked user can redeem the blocker's invite link, and it then gets used as a content channel (B receives “from Duo's worlds” bonus items).	While A blocks B: open A's link 3 logged out → sign in as B → Daily Five shows “From Duo + others' worlds.” (54, 59)
C3	Partly correct answers are graded wrong, against “fail toward the player.”	Richard III deformities → answer “hunchback” (or “withered arm” in Catch-up) → ✕ although the feedback says “Right deformity / Half right.” (16, 31)
C4	Friendship state is inconsistent across surfaces: “People you invited” shows Accepted, the invite flow says “already friends,” the friends list and search show no friendship, and B's list is empty.	Compare screens 48, 50, 51, 59 for the same A ↔ B pair.

SHOULD-FIX

ID	ISSUE	EVIDENCE
S1	In-round progress dots put bonus answers in base slots, show all filled before Q5, and home's aria label says “2 of 5 answered” with 5 filled.	09, 15, 58, 27
S2	Color alone shows status: green/red result dots (round + home), you-vs-friend overlap bubbles, invite chip dots, grey mastery legend.	27, 53, 47, 35
S3	Catch-up gives 0.25× points (a penalty for missing a day) and brings back a just-answered question as “From yesterday.”	29, 30
S4	The SMS reminder takeover reappears on every login after “Not right now.”	05, 66
S5	Bonus questions are served before base questions 4–5.	15
S6	Topic chip gives away the answer (“Catch-22” chip on the Catch-22 question).	09

S7	“See my recap” opens last week’s ceremony; the date range is 8 days but says “Seven days”; slide 4 text overlaps the CTA.	18, 21
S8	Next-round time contradicts itself: “tomorrow at 1 PM” vs “Saturday’s five arrive at noon.”	27, 25
S9	The friend-request note isn’t shown to the recipient.	64, 67
S10	A re-request after a decline fails silently and reveals the decline.	70
S11	Friends badge still shows “1” after declining.	68
S12	Auth errors are off-screen with no live region, and there’s no resend-code control.	02, 04
S13	Points are a hero metric (share card “200 points,” friend point totals, “x of y” round score), which drifts toward scoreboard mechanics.	23, 52
S14	Taxonomy placement: user topic promoted to a top-level domain, misfiled territories, duplicate suggestions.	34
S15	Developer tools (reset round, noon reset, diagnostics) visible on the production profile.	40
S16	“Show me the answer” shows up as a user-typed bubble and counts as a red, wrong result.	55
S17	“Argue your point” gives no confirmation or outcome; the counter shows remaining characters as used; Submit is hidden under the answer bar.	11, 12
S18	Stranger discovery is ON while mutual-friend suggestions are OFF. Verify the consent defaults.	39
S19	Question author “Maid Acasa” (a non-friend) appears on every question; possible stranger-name exposure, and it contradicts “from Uno’s world.”	26, 29
S20	The summary’s floating “next five” panel covers content; the + button covers controls on several pages.	25, 39

NICE-TO-HAVE

ID	ISSUE
N1	Portrait cards are headed “Joshing” instead of the player’s name; the friend’s portrait says “YOUR knowledge portrait.”
N2	“+3 more territories” doesn’t add up to “15 territories.”
N3	Escape doesn’t close the territory modal.

N4	Rate-limit countdown doesn't tick and stays visible after it's no longer relevant.
N5	Self-search returns "No matching player found."
N6	"0m ago" copy; "follow you" wording on the Blocked page (there's no follow concept).
N7	Wrong-answer headline varies by flow ("You'll know this one next time" vs "Not this time — here's the answer").
N8	"What you mastered" lists Establishing → Familiar moves.
N9	"Not for me" sheet points to non-existent "Settings > Hidden questions" / "Manage your topics."
N10	Friends empty state says "You haven't invited anyone yet."
N11	OTP placeholder shows the test code "000000"; input has no label or maxlength.
N12	Terms copy is duplicated on the login card.
N13	"Skipped. We'll bring it back later." is low contrast on the patterned background.
N14	Setup: no avatar step, silent validation, sticky footer covers "Add your own."
N15	Search results aren't tappable (no path to a non-friend's profile or block).
N16	"Questions created 28 (you answered 0)" despite answering items "from Uno's world."
N17	Invite landing doesn't show the link's topic chips.
N18	Header isn't sticky: the "Lately" bell and profile scroll away on long pages.

7. Principle audit

PRINCIPLE	VERDICT	NOTES
No streaks / leaderboards / coercive mechanics	MOSTLY	No streak counters or leaderboards. Watch-outs: 0.25× catch-up points (S3), SMS takeover on every login (S4), “200 points this cycle” share hero and friend point totals (S13), “Questions created 28 (you answered 0)” reads like a debt.
Wrong answers feel like connection	STRONG	“Now it’s in yours too,” “Between us!,” and the empathetic diagnoses are excellent. Gap: nothing in the moment points you to a friend who knows the answer, or lets you react (see suggestions).
Color never carries meaning alone	FAILS	Result dots (green/red), common-ground bubbles, invite chip dots and the mastery legend all depend on color alone (S2).
Grading fails toward the player	PARTIAL	Typos and ambiguous names are handled well; half-right multi-part answers aren’t (C3). “Show me the answer” counts as wrong (S16).
Privacy / explicit consent	AT RISK	Block doesn’t sever the connection (C1); a blocked user can redeem the link (C2); stranger discovery ON (S18); author name of a non-friend on every question (S19).

8. Suggestions for improvement

Social graph & safety

- **Make block a hard edge.** On block, delete the friendship and pending requests, invalidate the blocker's invite links for that user, and exclude each person's content from the other's bonus pool. On unblock, restore nothing and say so. Add an automated test that asserts every surface (list, search, invite flow, bonus sourcing) agrees.
- **Use one source of truth for relationship state.** Derive “Accepted,” “already friends,” the list and search from the same query so they can't disagree.
- **Ghost-pending after a decline.** Show the sender “Requested” indefinitely (never “declined”), and quietly expire it. This protects the decliner and removes the confusing silent reset.
- **Name the question author honestly.** If “Maid Acasa” is a house or AI voice, give it a clear badge (“Joshing Kitchen”). If it's a person, show the name only when there's a consented connection.
- **Default stranger discovery to OFF**, and explain it at the moment it would first trigger (“You and Sam both nailed 3 Sondheim questions — want to be discoverable to people like this?”).

Grading & the wrong-answer moment

- **Partial credit toward correct.** For multi-part answers, count any correct component as correct (“Locked in — and the withered arm too”). Keep ✕ for answers that are actually wrong.
- **Treat “Show me the answer” as curiosity, not failure.** Use a neutral dot (hollow with a small eye glyph), not red, and render it as a system event, not a user bubble.
- **Close the connection loop on misses.** After a wrong answer, show which friend knows this territory (“Uno is Familiar with Mozart — ask them about it?”) with a one-tap reaction or question. This is the product's stated promise, and it's currently missing from the flow.
- **Make appeals visible.** Confirm “We'll take another look,” and report the outcome in Lately. If an appeal succeeds, turn the dot green retroactively.

Progress, recap & time

- **Redesign the progress track** so shape carries meaning: ✓ filled circle, ✕ ring with a slash, ○ skipped, ★ bonus (separate row). Fill bonus dots only from bonus answers, and serve bonuses after base question 5.
- **Drop the catch-up multiplier.** Missing a day shouldn't cost anything. If points must differ, say so positively (“Catch-up doesn't count toward this week, it's just for you”).
- **Use one clock.** Pull “next five” copy from a single server value in the user's timezone everywhere.

- **Recap routing:** after a round, “See my recap” should open *today’s* summary. Offer an unseen weekly ceremony as a secondary card.
- **Share cards should celebrate territory, not points** (“Crossed into Familiar in American City Nicknames”). Move points out of the hero slot.

Onboarding & reminders

- Pin errors next to the field that caused them with `role="alert"`, and scroll them into view. Add “Resend code (0:30).”
- Remember “Not right now” for the SMS takeover (at least 30 days) and move the setting into Profile > Notifications.
- Show the invite link's topic chips on the landing page, and give existing users a “You're now connected with Duo” confirmation.
- Add an optional avatar or initial-color picker to setup, and explain why Continue is disabled.

Knowledge map

- File user-added territories under the closest existing domain (Catch-22 → Literature), and let the user move them.
- Give the mastery legend distinct shapes or fills, and put the numeric value in each bubble at legible contrast.
- Use the player's name in portrait headers, and “Uno's knowledge portrait” on friend pages.
- Remove role-gated Developer tools from player builds, or hide them behind an admin flag.

Screenshot IDs in the tables (for example “16”) match the file names of the captured screens. No console errors or uncaught exceptions were logged during testing.